

1.5 How we work: our sprints and ceremonies

Learning objectives

What are these sprint ceremonies?

- **Daily stand-up** = To coordinate work, identify impediments (blockers), and ensure the team is on track to meet the Sprint Goal. It is NOT a status report to the manager.
- **Backlog refinement** = To ensure the backlog is "Ready" for Sprint Planning. The team discusses, estimates (pointing), clarifies assumptions, and breaks down larger stories.
- **Sprint planning** = To select the highest-priority work from the "Ready" backlog and create a forecast of what the team can realistically deliver in the upcoming sprint, defining the Sprint Goal.
- **Sprint review and demos** = To coordinate work, identify impediments (blockers), and ensure the team is on track to meet the Sprint Goal. It is NOT a status report to the manager.
- **Retro** = The dedicated time for inspecting the process and defining actions for continuous improvement across people, process, and tools.
- **Three Amigos (this one sits slightly outside the normal team rhythm — find out why)** = To design, elaborate, and refine requirements into actionable user stories, ensuring they are clear, testable, and feasible. This moves the "basic summary" to a well-defined story.

Task

I sat through a daily stand-up, and there was mention of a backlog. The backlog is in Jira and shows all the work for 1–3 sprints. Depending on how much planning Hamza has done, he is the one who will set the tasks for the sprint, as he is the lead engineering manager. You also have your board, which shows the current tickets/work tasks you need to do. Not everything should be on the board. Usually, when a new sprint starts for that two-week period, the work that needs to be done in that time is put onto your board.

Overall

- **Backlog** = all work/tasks you need to do.
- **Board** = the work you have to do for just that one sprint.

Question / Queries / Push back

Push back = I knew what most of the other ceremonies in the learning objectives were, but the Three Amigos was a completely

new concept to me.